AUWA Website Specification — auwa.life

Created: April 2026. The specification for the auwa.life website — the brand's home and editorial hub. Load when building the website, planning content, or working on site structure.

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1. Purpose & Positioning

The auwa.life website is the front door to the AUWA brand. It establishes AUWA as a Japanese lifestyle brand rooted in philosophical awareness before the app, store, or book exist as products. The website is the first thing anyone encounters — it needs to communicate the world, not just announce a product.

What it IS: A Kinfolk-inspired editorial destination. Atmospheric, contemplative, photography-led, with journal articles as the heartbeat. A place you visit to feel something, read something beautiful, and understand what AUWA is about.

What it is NOT: A product launch page. A teaser page with an email form. A feature list. A marketing funnel. It's a brand world — the kind of site you'd bookmark and return to.

Structural references:

- **Kinfolk** (kinfolk.com) — The gold standard. Serif typography, generous whitespace, atmospheric photography, editorial authority. The grid layout of articles creates a magazine-like feel that rewards browsing.
- **Cereal** (readcereal.com) — Minimal, travel-focused, serif-heavy. Beautiful article layouts with photography that breathes.
- **Monocle** (monocle.com) — Editorial worldview extended across products, retail, and media. Clean, confident, opinionated.
- **It's Nice That** (itsnicethat.com) — Design culture editorial. Clean grid, strong typography, content-led.
- **Mubi** (mubi.com) — Dark, cinematic, serif display type. Proves dark-mode editorial can feel premium and inviting.
- **Hoshinoya** (hoshinoya.com) — Japanese luxury hospitality. Atmospheric, slow, immersive. The photography integration and pacing.
- **Aesop** (aesop.com) — Restraint as luxury. Serif type, dark palette, every detail considered.

Additional references to study:

- **The Kinfolk Table** layout style — how Kinfolk handles food/culture/travel photography within article pages
- **Apartamento** (apartamentomagazine.com) — Raw, intimate editorial photography
- **Analogue Life** (analoguelife.com) — Japanese craft curation, beautiful product storytelling
- **Snow Peak** (snowpeak.com) — How a Japanese brand presents philosophy alongside products

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2. Site Architecture

All sections live under **auwa.life** with subpaths. All variants (auwalife.com, www.auwalife.com, www.auwa.life) 301 redirect to auwa.life. Google Search Console verified with sitemap submitted. Vercel project name: auwa-life.

```
auwa.life/                  → Home (editorial hub + brand introduction)
auwa.life/journal           → Journal index (all articles)
auwa.life/journal/[slug]    → Individual article
auwa.life/app               → Kokoro Mirror introduction (pre-launch: coming soon with email capture)
auwa.life/store             → Store introduction (pre-launch: coming soon with craftsman preview)
auwa.life/book              → The AUWA story universe (pre-launch: introduction + email capture)
auwa.life/about             → Tom & Rieko, the philosophy, the origin
auwa.life/brand             → Living style guide (logo, colours, typography, spacing, components)
```

Information Architecture

Home is the editorial hub — not a static landing page but a living, updating page anchored by journal content. Think Kinfolk's homepage: a hero article, a curated grid of recent pieces, and subtle navigation into the four pillars.

Journal is the SEO engine and the content heartbeat. Long-form articles, craftsman profiles, seasonal essays, Japan travel stories. This is where brand authority accumulates and where organic search traffic lands.

App, Store, Book pages are initially lightweight — atmospheric introductions that establish what's coming, with email capture. They become full sections as each pillar launches.

About tells the story of Tom and Rieko, the philosophy of Yaoyorozu no Kami, and the origin of AUWA. Written in the brand voice: quiet, precise, present.

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3. Page Layouts

Home Page (Implemented)

The homepage uses a scroll-driven stacked-card flipbook hero inspired by Obsidian Assembly, followed by editorial content sections. All images have rounded corners (`rounded-xl`). Lenis smooth scrolling active site-wide. Page transitions crossfade between routes.

Structure (top to bottom):

1. **Header** — AUWA wordmark (EB Garamond, SVG) left-aligned. Navigation right: Journal, Store, App, Book, About. Instrument Sans, tracked. White background, sticky, stays visible during flipbook scroll. Hides on scroll down elsewhere, shows on scroll up.
2. **Flipbook hero** — Stacked portrait cards (Obsidian Assembly pattern). 10 cards mixing product shots, editorial photography, and a video. Cards centred on screen, scroll-driven. Desktop: three-column layout with pillar label left, card centre, heading text right. Mobile/tablet: card centred with text pinned at bottom. First card is a looping video of the AUWA character. Cards are clickable (link to their pillar page). See `hero-flipbook-v4b.tsx` .

3. **Three pillar cards** — Book, Store, App. Portrait 4:5 aspect, rounded corners, gradient overlay with pillar name. Staggered cascade fade-up animation (150ms stagger). Each links to its teaser page.
4. **Micro-season** — 72 micro-season kanji display. Breathing room between pillars and editorial content.
5. **Latest articles (horizontal scroll)** — 11 article cards in a horizontal scrolling row. Native scroll (no momentum hijacking). Each card: 4:5 portrait image, rounded corners, category label, title, excerpt (55 chars max).
6. **AUWA face video** — Full-width rounded video of the AUWA character face-on with moving shadows. Landscape on desktop (16:9), square on mobile. Auto-plays when visible, pauses when not. Links to `/store`.
7. **Two-up articles** — Onsen Lesson + Nozawa Fire Festival. Two large portrait cards side by side. Staggered cascade animation.
8. **Meet AUWA video moment** — Portrait video of the AUWA character in a rounded card (left on desktop, stacked on mobile) with descriptive text alongside. Video and heading link to `/journal/the-beginning`. "The story behind AUWA" link goes to `/about`.
9. **72 Seasons feature** — Large portrait card with text overlay. Links to the 72 Seasons article.
10. **Footer** — Dark (`bg-void`), sticky at bottom with parallax reveal effect (content slides over it as you scroll). "Stay close." newsletter signup, pillar links, copyright + social icons.

Journal Index

Structure:

- Page title: "Journal" in Cormorant
- Filter/category tags: Seasons, Craft, Travel, Philosophy (Instrument Sans, subtle)
- Article grid: Kinfolk-style cards, atmospheric photography, varied sizes
- Pagination or infinite scroll (start with pagination — cleaner, more intentional)

Journal Article Page (Implemented)

The most important page. Built with a content block system designed to map cleanly to Sanity CMS portable text.

Layout structure (top to bottom):

- **Hero** — Split layout: image left (4:5 portrait on mobile, fills viewport height on desktop), title + subtitle right-aligned
- **Meta row** — Category link, author/photographer credit (12px uppercase), social share icons (Facebook, Pinterest, X). Full-width border below.
- **Article body** — Content blocks grouped into layout sections by a `groupIntoSections()` algorithm:
    - **Text-only sections** — Text and pullquotes, always positioned on the right half (`md:ml-[50%]`). This alignment is consistent throughout the article.
    - **Image-beside sections** — Image on the left (4:5 portrait, with extra right padding to make it visually smaller), text on the right in a 50/50 grid. Text blocks that follow an image are automatically grouped beside it.

    - **Image-pair sections** — Two side-by-side images, full width, each with its own caption. Used for detail/close-up photography.
    - **Pullquotes** — EB Garamond (upright, never italic) at clamp(1.75rem, 3.5vw, 2.75rem), full opacity. Matches the homepage pullquote treatment; italic would break that consistency.
- **Full-width divider** — `border-void/8`
- **Continue reading** — 3 related article cards in a grid
- **Footer** — The shared footer component handles the newsletter signup ("Stay close.") and pillar links. No per-page newsletter section needed.

Content block types (maps to Sanity CMS):

```
type ContentBlock =
  | { type: "text"; text: string }
  | { type: "image"; src: string; alt: string; caption?: string }
  | { type: "image-pair"; images: [{ src, alt, caption? }, { src, alt, caption? }] }
  | { type: "pullquote"; text: string }
```

The order of content blocks in the CMS determines the article layout. No manual layout selection needed — the grouping algorithm handles it automatically.

App Page (Pre-Launch)

- Atmospheric hero (dark, orb glow or AUWA character illustration)
- One line: "A daily awareness practice. Reveal your kokoro."
- Brief poetic description (3-4 sentences, Cormorant)
- Email capture: "Be the first to know."
- No screenshots, no feature lists, no pricing

Store Page (Pre-Launch)

- Atmospheric hero (craftsman photography from Monolise research trips)
- One line: "Lifetime objects with kokoro."
- Brief description of the philosophy (craft over disposability, every object chosen because a master poured their spirit into making it)
- 2-3 preview images of the kinds of objects that will be available
- Email capture: "Be the first to know."

Book Page (Pre-Launch)

- Atmospheric hero (illustration from AUWA stories)
- One line: "A cosmic being who reveals the kokoro in all things."
- Brief introduction to the series of illustrated stories
- Illustration samples (2-3 atmospheric images)
- Email capture

About Page

- Tom & Rieko's story (short, in brand voice, with photography)

- The philosophy of Yaoyorozu no Kami (accessible, not academic)
- The origin of AUWA (the name, the decade of development)
- The Eshi + Hanmoto model (brief, charming)
- Photography of Tom and Rieko (atmospheric, not corporate headshots)

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4. Design System (Implemented)

The living reference for the built website. See also the brand page at auwa.life/brand for a visual style guide.

Typography (Locked)

- **Display + Editorial:** EB Garamond (400, 500, 600, 700; normal + italic) — `font-display` in Tailwind
- **Functional / UI:** Instrument Sans (400, 500, 600) — `font-sans` in Tailwind
- **Japanese:** Noto Sans JP (300, 400) — `font-jp`; Noto Serif JP (400, 600) — `font-jp-serif`
- All loaded via `next/font/google` with `display: swap`

Type sizing rules:

- 12px — uppercase metadata labels (card categories, author credits). Tracking: 0.08em
- 13px — uppercase interactive labels (journal filters, micro-season link, image captions). Tracking: 0.06em
- 14px — all UI text (navigation, excerpts, form inputs, buttons, copyright). Tracking varies by context
- 18-19px — article body text (EB Garamond). Line-height: 1.85
- 18-20px — about page prose (EB Garamond). Line-height: 1.7
- 20-22px — card titles, pillar headings (EB Garamond). Tracking: 0.01em
- 28-32px — section headings ("Continue reading", "Stay close", "The name"). Tracking: 0.01em
- clamp(2.5rem, 5.5vw, 4.5rem) — page titles (h1). Tracking: 0.01em
- clamp(1.75rem, 3.5vw, 2.75rem) — pullquotes (EB Garamond, upright). Tracking: 0.005em. Pullquotes are never italic — in-article and homepage treatments match.
- clamp(3rem, 8vw, 6.5rem) — micro-season kanji (Noto Serif JP). Tracking: 0.06em

Form CTA buttons use `font-medium` (500 weight) across all pages. All other UI text is weight 400.

Colour (Light Theme)

The website uses a pure white background with the void/cosmic palette for text. This is the Kinfolk-inspired editorial expression of the brand — the dark palette lives in the app, social, and newsletter modules.

- **Page background:** Pure white — `oklch(1 0 0)` / `--color-surface`
- **Raised surfaces:** `oklch(0.95 0.005 250)` / `--color-surface-raised`
- **Text colour:** `--color-void` (`oklch(0.08 0.025 250)`) at opacity levels:
  - 100% — headings, titles, active nav
  - 80% — about page prose, footer category links
  - 70% — nav links, hover states, founder bios
  - 60% — subtitles, article subtitle
  - 50% — excerpts, captions
  - 45% — "Read the latest" arrow link

    - 40% — metadata labels, filter buttons (inactive), social share icons
    - 35% — input placeholder text
- **Borders:** void at 8% (dividers), 20% (form underlines), 50% (form focus)
- **Dark module (newsletter):** `bg-void` with white text at similar opacity levels

Spacing & Layout (Implemented)

Responsive horizontal padding (page-level gutter):

- Mobile: 24px (`px-6`)
- Tablet: 48px (`md:px-12`)
- Desktop: 80px (`lg:px-20`)
- XL: 112px (`xl:px-28`)

Vertical section spacing (standard rhythm):

- Regular sections: `pb-16 md:pb-24` (64px / 96px) — the default for all modules
- Hero top padding: `pt-12 md:pt-16` (48px / 64px) — intentionally tighter
- Micro-season module: `py-24 md:py-36` (96px / 144px) — standalone moment, extra breathing room
- Newsletter module: `py-28 md:py-40` (112px / 160px) — generous, dark background module
- Footer category links: `py-16 md:py-24` (matches standard)
- Header height: `h-16 md:h-20` (64px / 80px)

Grid gaps:

- Article grid (journal index): `gap-x-6 md:gap-x-8 gap-y-12 md:gap-y-16`
- Pillar cards (home): `gap-5 md:gap-6 lg:gap-8`
- Horizontal scroll (home): `gap-5 md:gap-6 lg:gap-8`
- Image pairs (article): `gap-4 md:gap-6`
- Founder bios (about): `gap-8 md:gap-16`

Content widths:

- Article body text: right half of viewport (`md:ml-[50%]`)
- About page prose: `max-w-[680px]` centred
- Newsletter form: `max-w-[400px]` centred within `max-w-[480px]` container
- Waitlist forms: `max-w-[440px]`
- Horizontal scroll cards: `w-[260px] md:w-[280px] lg:w-[300px]`

Image aspect ratios:

- Primary (cards, articles, editorial): 4:5 portrait — the standard ratio everywhere
- Book cover: 3:4 portrait
- Image break (about page): 2.5:1 landscape
- Article hero (mobile): 4:5 portrait; (desktop): fills viewport height

Motion (Implemented)

Uses a custom `FadeIn` client component with IntersectionObserver (not Framer Motion).

- **Easing:** `cubic-bezier(0.16, 1, 0.3, 1)` — ease-out-expo
- **FadeIn duration:** 800ms default
- **FadeIn translateY:** 12px rise
- **FadeIn root margin:** `"0px 0px -40px 0px"` — triggers 40px before entering viewport
- **Stagger delays:** 60-100ms per item (grid cards, nav items)
- **Hover transitions:** 300ms with `transition-colors duration-300`
- **Header scroll:** Hides on scroll down, shows on scroll up (no animation library, pure React state)
- **Mobile menu:** 500ms opacity transition with staggered nav item reveals

Photography Treatment

All photography follows brand.md Section 6. Portrait-first (4:5) for all editorial and card imagery — no landscape images in article layouts or grids.

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5. Technical Architecture

Stack

- **Framework:** Next.js 15 (App Router, React Server Components, webpack)
- **Styling:** Tailwind CSS 4 (PostCSS plugin, OKLCH colour system via `@theme inline` in globals.css)
- **CMS:** Sanity (headless — not yet integrated; content currently hardcoded as placeholder data)
- **Hosting:** Vercel (automatic deployments, edge functions, image optimisation)
- **Email:** Resend (fully integrated — welcome emails auto-send on signup, newsletter sends via API). Templates in `src/emails/` using React Email (`@react-email/components`).
- **Analytics:** Vercel Analytics (`@vercel/analytics/react` , added to `layout.tsx`). Privacy-respecting, no cookie banner needed, GDPR compliant.
- **Fonts:** Google Fonts via next/font (EB Garamond, Instrument Sans, Noto Sans JP, Noto Serif JP)

Sanity Content Model

```
// Journal Article
{
  title: string
  slug: slug
  publishedAt: datetime
  category: reference → Category
  heroImage: image (with hotspot)
  excerpt: text
  body: portable text (rich text with images, pull quotes, embeds)
  author: reference → Author
  seoTitle: string
  seoDescription: text
  relatedArticles: array of references → Article
}
```

```
// Category
{
  title: string  // Seasons, Craft, Travel, Philosophy
  slug: slug
  description: text
}

// Author
{
  name: string
  role: string
  image: image
  bio: text
}

// Page (for App, Store, Book, About — editable)
{
  title: string
  slug: slug
  heroImage: image
  body: portable text
  seoTitle: string
  seoDescription: text
}

// Newsletter subscribers are handled directly via Resend Contacts API.
// No Sanity schema needed. See context/newsletter.md for details.
```

Image Pipeline

- Sanity's image CDN handles responsive sizing, format conversion (WebP/AVIF), and cropping
- All images uploaded at 2x resolution minimum (2400px wide for full-width heroes)
- Hotspot cropping set in Sanity Studio for each image (ensures correct focal point across aspect ratios)
- Lazy loading for below-fold images (Next.js Image component handles this)
- Target: 95+ Lighthouse performance score

Component Library

Reusable components live in `src/components/`. All are server components unless noted.

Component	File	Client?	Purpose

Header	`header.tsx`	Yes	Rendered once in `layout.tsx` (outside `PageTransition`) so the logo + menu button stay above page-leave animations. `transparent` mode inferred from pathname (`/` only). Mobile menu is portalled to body. Morphing hamburger→X via inline-style transitions. Logo fades out when menu opens.
Footer	`footer.tsx`	No	"Stay close" newsletter signup (dark), pillar links, copyright + social icons. Sticky at bottom with parallax reveal.
SignupForm	`signup-form.tsx`	Yes	Email signup form. Props: `source` (app-waitlist / store-waitlist / book-waitlist / newsletter), `buttonText`, `successMessage`, `theme` (light/dark), `className`. Posts to `/api/signup`.
FadeIn	`fade-in.tsx`	Yes	IntersectionObserver-based animation. Two variants: `"fade"` (default, 12px rise) and `"reveal"` (24px rise, for image cards). Accepts `className`, `delay`, `duration`, `variant`.
TextReveal	`text-reveal.tsx`	Yes	Word-by-word text animation. Splits text into words, each rises from below with stagger. For hero headlines. Props: `as` (tag), `delay`, `stagger`.
SmoothScroll	`smooth-scroll.tsx`	Yes	Lenis smooth scrolling wrapper. Wraps children in layout.tsx.
PageTransition	`page-transition.tsx`	Yes	Crossfade transition on route change (500ms). Wraps children in layout.tsx.
HeroFlipbookV4b	`hero-flipbook-v4b.tsx`	Yes	Stacked-card flipbook hero. 10 cards (video + images). Scroll-driven. Obsidian Assembly-style.
HeroVideo	`hero-video.tsx`	Yes	Video hero with poster fallback. Portrait/landscape responsive. Used on `/home-1`.
VideoMoment	`video-moment.tsx`	Yes	"Meet AUWA" section: portrait video card + text. Desktop: side-by-side. Mobile: stacked.
AuwaVideoBlock	`auwa-video-block.tsx`	Yes	Full-width AUWA face video. Landscape desktop, square mobile. Auto-plays on visibility.
MicroSeason	`micro-season.tsx`	Yes	Displays current 72 micro-season with kanji.
ObfuscatedEmail	`obfuscated-email.tsx`	Yes	Bot-proof email display. Shows `user[at]domain` initially, reveals real `mailto:` link on click. Props: `user`, `domain`.

API routes:

Route	Purpose
`/api/signup`	Creates Resend contact + sends welcome email. Accepts `{ email, source }`.
`/api/newsletter/send`	Sends newsletter to full audience. Accepts content JSON + secret token.

Email templates (in `src/emails/`, React Email components, not rendered on the website):

Template	Purpose

`welcome.tsx`	Auto-sent on signup. 4 variants based on source.
`newsletter.tsx`	Manual newsletter sends. Accepts heading, intro, articles array, hero image.

SEO

- Dynamic meta tags per page (title, description, OG image)
- Structured data (JSON-LD) for articles (Article schema)
- Sitemap auto-generated
- Canonical URLs
- Journal articles are the primary SEO asset — target long-tail keywords around Japanese philosophy, craft, seasonal living, awareness

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6. Build Approach

v0 / Stitch Prompt Ideas

Use v0.dev or Stitch to rapidly scaffold pages, then refine in Claude Code. Prompts should be specific and reference-heavy:

Homepage prompt: "Create a dark-mode editorial homepage inspired by Kinfolk magazine. Serif display typography (Cormorant), sans-serif navigation (Inter or similar). Full-width hero with atmospheric photography and large headline overlay. Below: a brand statement line centred with generous whitespace, then a 3-column asymmetric article card grid (varied card sizes, dark backgrounds, warm photography). Minimal footer with wordmark. Overall feel: Japanese luxury hospitality meets design magazine. Colour: near-black backgrounds (#0f0f14), off-white text (#dddde2), subtle yellow-green accent (#c4cc5a). Tailwind CSS."

Article page prompt: "Create a long-form article page with dark background. Full-width hero image with parallax. Large serif headline (Cormorant) centred below hero. Article body in a narrow column (max 680px) with generous line-height. Pull quotes in larger serif, centred. Full-width photography interspersed. Author block at bottom. Related article cards (2-3) below. Newsletter signup at end. Dark, atmospheric, editorial. Think Cereal magazine online."

Journal index prompt: "Create a magazine-style article index page with dark background. Page title in large serif. Filter row with category tags. Article cards in asymmetric grid — mix of large (spanning 2 columns) and standard cards. Each card: atmospheric image, serif headline, one-line excerpt, category badge. Hover: subtle scale and brightness shift. Kinfolk/Cereal aesthetic. Dark mode."

Build Timeline (Achievable in a Few Days)

Day 1: Scaffold + Homepage

- Set up Next.js 16 + Tailwind 4 + Sanity
- Scaffold homepage layout (v0/Stitch for initial structure, Claude Code for refinement)
- Configure fonts (Cormorant, Instrument Sans, Noto Sans JP)
- Implement colour system (OKLCH custom properties in Tailwind config)
- Homepage: header, hero, brand statement, article grid (with placeholder content), newsletter signup, footer

Day 2: Article Pages + Journal Index

- Journal article page template (the most important page)
- Journal index with category filtering
- Sanity content model for articles, categories, authors
- Sanity Studio configured with preview
- Responsive testing across breakpoints

Day 3: Remaining Pages + Polish

- App, Store, Book pre-launch pages (atmospheric, simple)
- About page
- Newsletter integration (Resend)
- Motion: scroll reveals, hover states, page transitions
- SEO: meta tags, OG images, structured data
- Performance optimisation, Lighthouse audit
- Deploy to Vercel, connect domain

Day 4: Content Population

- Populate initial journal articles (see Section 7)
- Final photography treatment and upload
- Cross-browser testing
- Soft launch

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7. Preparing Initial Articles (The Day-One Content Plan)

The website needs content on day one. An empty journal undermines the editorial positioning. Aim for 8-10 articles prepared and ready to publish at launch — a mix that showcases the four content territories (seasons, craft, travel, philosophy) and gives the site enough density to feel established.

Article Preparation Approach

Tom and Rieko can prepare ~10 articles in a focused day using this workflow:

1. **Select 10 topics** from the list below
2. **Gather photography** from Tom's 15+ year Japan catalogue (already shot, just needs selection and Lightroom treatment)
3. **Write first drafts** — Tom writes in brand voice, 800-1500 words per article. Some can be shorter (500-word seasonal reflections). Use Claude to help draft, then edit for voice and authenticity.
4. **Rieko reviews** for cultural accuracy and adds Japanese terms/context
5. **Apply photography treatment** (Lightroom "AUWA — Atmospheric" preset)
6. **Upload to Sanity** with metadata, hero images, categories, SEO descriptions

Suggested Initial Articles

Seasons (2-3 articles):

- "The Fifth Day" — An introduction to how Japan divides the year into 72 micro-seasons, and what it means to notice the world in five-day increments. Photography: seasonal Japan landscapes.
- "Seimei (清明): The Light Returns" — A seasonal essay tied to the current micro-season at launch. Atmospheric, personal, grounded in a specific place and moment in Japan.

Craft (2-3 articles):

- "The Knife Maker of Seki" — Profile of a craftsman Tom and Rieko met during their Monolise research. The story of a lifetime spent perfecting a single craft. Photography from the workshop visit.
- "Objects with Kokoro" — An essay on the philosophy of choosing lifetime objects over disposable ones. Why a hand-forged knife or a ceramic cup from a master artisan changes your relationship with daily life.
- "What Wabi-Sabi Actually Means" — Reclaiming the concept from Instagram aesthetics. What it means to find beauty in imperfection and impermanence, beyond the interiors trend.

Travel (2-3 articles):

- "Temple Mornings" — An atmospheric essay about the ritual of visiting Japanese temples at dawn. The silence, the light, the practice of being present. Photography: Tom's temple work.
- "The Onsen Lesson" — On the Japanese bathing culture and what it teaches about shared space, vulnerability, and attention. Not a guide — a reflection.

Philosophy (2-3 articles):

- "Everything Has Kokoro" — The foundational essay. An accessible introduction to Yaoyorozu no Kami and why it matters in modern life. The philosophical anchor for the entire journal.
- "Awareness, Not Mindfulness" — Why AUWA uses the word "awareness" instead of "mindfulness." The difference between a Western self-help concept and a Japanese philosophical worldview.
- "The Guest" — On being a respectful visitor to Japan (and to any culture). The awareness that comes from understanding you are in someone else's home. Photography: Japan travel moments.

Content Calendar (Post-Launch)

After the initial 10 articles, publish 1-2 articles per week aligned with the 72 micro-seasons content calendar. Each micro-season (5 days) is an opportunity for a seasonal essay, craftsman profile, or travel piece. This gives the journal a natural rhythm without feeling forced.

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8. Newsletter & Email

Fully documented in `context/newsletter.md`. Summary:

- **Welcome emails** auto-send on signup (4 variants per source: newsletter, app-waitlist, store-waitlist, book-waitlist). Sent as transactional via `resend.emails.send()`. Unsubscribe is a plain `mailto:hello@auwa.life?subject=Unsubscribe` because the `{{{RESEND_UNSUBSCRIBE_URL}}}` merge var does not substitute in transactional sends.
- **Welcome email subjects**: "Welcome to AUWA" (newsletter) · "You're on the AUWA App waitlist" (app) · "A note from AUWA." (store and book — softer subject keeps them out of Gmail Promotions).

- **Newsletter sends** go through Resend's **Broadcasts API** (`resend.broadcasts.create()` + `.send()`), not the transactional Emails API. This is what enables the `{{{RESEND_UNSUBSCRIBE_URL}}}` merge variable and the `List-Unsubscribe` header. Triggered manually via the `/send-newsletter` slash command or the `/api/newsletter/send` endpoint.
- **Signup points**: shared footer on every page ("Quiet letters."), plus dedicated forms on app/store/book teaser pages
- **Templates**: React Email components in `src/emails/` (welcome.tsx, newsletter.tsx)
- **Resend segments**: App Waitlist, Store Waitlist, Book Waitlist (3 segments, free plan limit). Newsletter subscribers go to audience without a segment.
- **Subject format**: `[Topic] | AUWA` — poetic, not clickbait

Social share previews (journal articles)

Each article has a dedicated 1200×630 landscape OG image at `/journal/{slug}/{slug}-og.jpg`, alongside the portrait 4:5 hero. `generateMetadata()` in `src/app/journal/[slug]/page.tsx` derives the OG path from the hero filename. FB, Pinterest, and X pull this image into their link previews. Instagram is intentionally not supported — IG has no link-share flow. To regenerate after a hero change:

```
cd website/main/public/journal/{slug} && cp {slug}-hero.jpg {slug}-og.jpg && \
  sips --resampleWidth 1200 {slug}-og.jpg && sips -c 630 1200 {slug}-og.jpg
```

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9. Analytics & Performance

- **Vercel Analytics** — installed and live. `@vercel/analytics/react` in `layout.tsx`. Privacy-respecting, no cookie consent banner needed.
- **Key metrics:** Page views, unique visitors, time on page (especially journal articles), newsletter signups (conversion rate by page), referral sources
- **Lighthouse target:** 95+ across all categories
- **Core Web Vitals:** LCP < 2.5s, FID < 100ms, CLS < 0.1

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